

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Ms EMMA NATALIE CHOULES

Address: 5 Buckingham Court 9 Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JJ

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: As a neighbouring resident of the former ambulance station, I wish to object to the proposed development on the grounds of highway safety, parking impact, residential amenity, noise disturbance, overdevelopment, and harm to local character.

There is already a pending application at Buckingham Court (Ref: DM2025/00363) for six additional residential units, and local residents have raised concerns about cumulative parking stress from that proposal. The combined impact of both schemes would worsen existing congestion and should be assessed together, as required under cumulative impact considerations.

1. Parking and Highway Safety

The proposal has the potential to generate significant vehicle movements, particularly for Friday gatherings where attendance could exceed 70 vehicles. The surrounding residential streets already experience peaktime congestion associated with Avenue Primary Academy, which has an early Friday finish. The additional influx of vehicles would create conflict between school traffic, residents, and visitors to the site. Dorset Road is a nothrough road with limited turning space, and the area does not have the capacity to safely accommodate eventbased traffic. Despite claims that most attendees will travel on foot, consultation comments show many supporters are from beyond walking distance, making this assumption unrealistic.

2. Impact on School Safety

The site is situated very close to Avenue Primary Academy (over 1,000 pupils). Additional traffic during peak school times would worsen congestion, increase unsafe manoeuvres, reduce visibility, and elevate risks to pupils and families. This represents an avoidable intensification of vehicle movements in an already pressured school zone.

3. Noise and LateEvening Disturbance

The proposed lateevening use (up to 11pm) and the dispersal of up to 250 attendees would cause

unavoidable noise from conversations, engines, car doors, and vehicle movements. This is incompatible with a quiet residential location.

Claims that the previous ambulance station operated 24 hours are misleading. As a resident for nine years, I experienced no comparable noise disturbance, and its historic use generated minimal latenight traffic. The proposed use represents a significant intensification.

4. Overdevelopment and Visual Impact

The proposed extensions, including an increased roof height, would create a visually dominant structure inconsistent with the existing domestic scale of surrounding homes. This would adversely affect the character and appearance of the neighbourhood.

In combination with the proposed Buckingham Court development, the raised roof would also create a sense of enclosure for neighbouring residents, contributing to an overdeveloped appearance.

Conclusion

The proposal represents an overintensive use of a constrained residential site, resulting in unacceptable harm to:

highway and pedestrian safety

residential amenity

local character

schooladjacent safety and congestion

For these reasons, I respectfully request that planning permission be refused.